

SNIPPETS

PCs and batteries recycled the most

The 2009 Annual Recycling Report from Earth911.com has declared computers and batteries as the most recycled materials last year. The other products that made it to the Top 10 list are televisions and CFLs.

India has 71 million Internet users

India's Internet users base grew by 42 per cent to reach 71 million in 2009, according to an annual survey by IMRB and Internet and Mobile Association of India. This rise can be attributed to the availability of cheaper devices, affordable broadband plans and the mushrooming of cyber cafes.

Mobiles, inverters to cost more in Delhi

With the Delhi Budget, state finance minister A.K. Wadia has raised taxes on almost all items, including electronics goods, mobiles and inverters. The budget has raised the value-added tax to 20 per cent from the current 12.5 per cent, in a bid to finance the 2010 Commonwealth Games.

DoT order hurts mobile subscribers base

Mobile operators may stop taking new subscribers if delays continue in the purchase of network equipment due to Department of Telecom's order that makes it mandatory to get security clearance before buying any hardware or software. The order had been issued in December 2009 and has been revised twice since then, which has completely halted the capacity building by mobile operators and is beginning to affect the quality of mobile services.

Canon to launch new products

Canon is planning to launch an array of products for the Indian subcontinent including a wide range of digital cameras, printers and copiers within the next three months. The company also stepped into the Rs 1.5-billion surveillance camera market in India six months ago.

C-DAC to unveil digital video technology

The Centre for Advanced Computing (C-DAC) is eyeing the upcoming Commonwealth Games to launch a digital video broadcast (DVB) technology. The new technology is a fully-automated translation and subtitle suite that will allow television viewers to select a language of their choice while watching a live programme.

Philips eyes government sector for LED bulbs

Philips Electronics is seeking government departments' support to push sales of light-emitting diode (LED) bulbs in the country. The firm has launched new LED streetlighting solutions that save power and require less maintenance. Some municipalities like the New Delhi Municipal Corporation have already implemented these.

Motorola, telcos tie-up for WiMAX

Motorola is talking with key cellular service providers in India for deployment of WiMAX. Telecom companies like Bharti, Vodafone, Idea, RCOM and the Tata have filed applications to acquire 3G spectrum for WiMAX.

Gujarat up for solar power billboards

The Gujarat government will soon introduce guidelines for introduction of solar-powered lighted billboards in the state. These boards will be installed in major cities like Ahmedabad, Vadodara, Surat, Rajkot, Jamnagar, Junagadh and Bhavnagar.

Bharti to merge with MTN

Bharti Airtel has merged with South Africa's MTN following its acquisition of Zain Telecom Africa operations. The deal has been closed at \$10.7 billion. This is the second largest acquisition by an Indian company after Tata Steel's \$13.6-billion acquisition of Anglo-Dutch steel maker Corus.

Okaya setting up tubular battery plant

Okaya Power is setting up a state-of-the-art manufacturing plant with a capacity of 1.2 million units per year at an investment of Rs 1370 million for producing world-class tubular batteries for inverters. Batteries would be produced in 80Ah, 100Ah, 120Ah, 135Ah, 150Ah, 165Ah and 180Ah capacities.

Okaya tubular batteries are made using Hadi high-pressure spine-casting machines. This ensures there are no casting related defects.

Schneider enters renewable energy, to acquire Zicom

Schneider Electric India, a wholly owned subsidiary of Paris-based Schneider Electric SA, has entered the renewable energy market in India with Xantrex. The Xantrex range has been rebranded as Schneider Electric globally to offer customers increased access to a wider range of integrated solutions.

The company is also planning to acquire Zicom Electronic Security System—India's largest independent electronic security system integrator.

"The exit from the integration business allowed the company to diversify into new businesses, alternative energy and aerospace engineering that have been identified and were seen as sunrise sectors, with huge growth and margin possibilities," said Manohar Bidaye, chairman, Zicom.

Videocon unveils nine mobile phones

Consumer electronics brand Videocon has launched nine new models of mobile handsets, thus enhancing its current offering from twelve handsets to a total of 21 handsets.

The key highlights of this range include triple-SIM CDMA handsets, QWERTY-keypad dual-SIM handsets with optical track pad, attractive touchscreen devices and dual-SIM multimedia, camera and music phones.